



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05780) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2025**

Courses Audience: **55**
Responses Received: **52**
Response Ratio: **94.5 %**

Subject Details

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Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Monday, January 26, 2026**

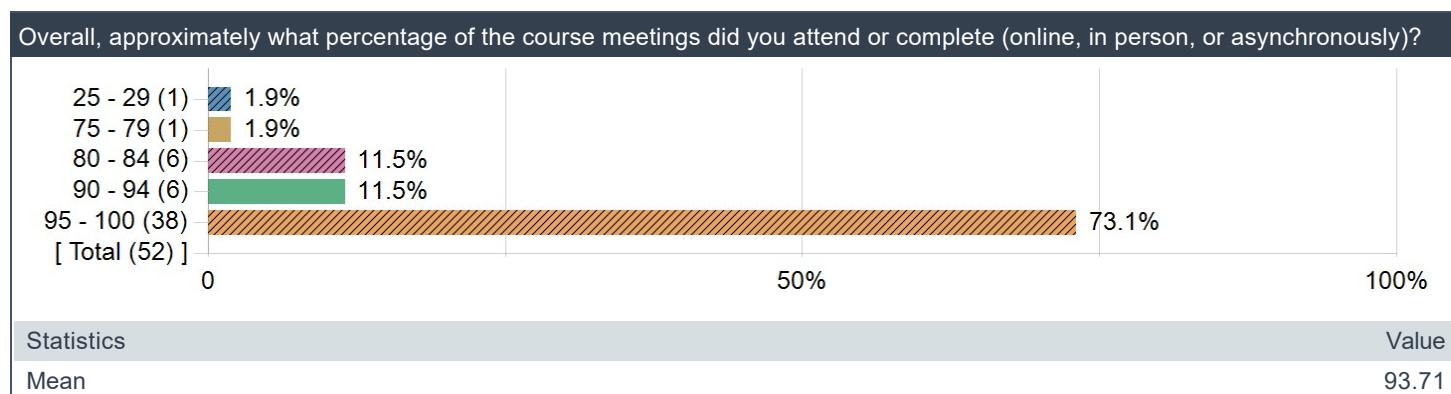
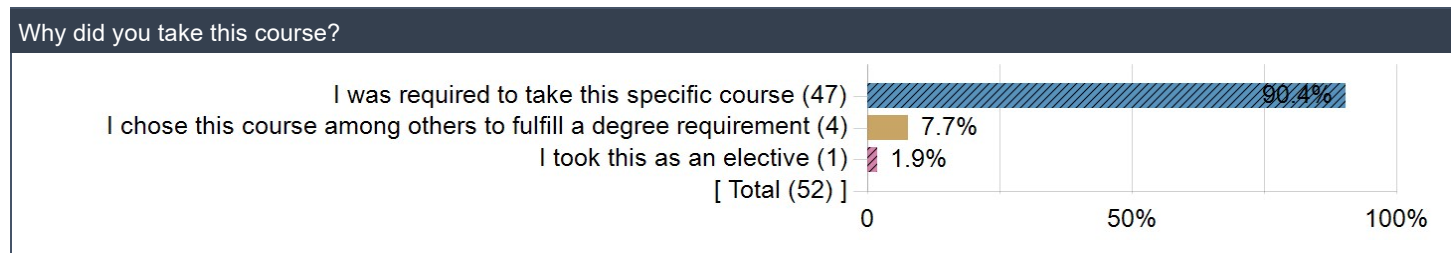
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	50.0%	30.8%	15.4%	3.8%	0.0%	52	4.27
The course was well organized.	36.5%	48.1%	7.7%	7.7%	0.0%	52	4.13
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	55.8%	36.5%	3.8%	3.8%	0.0%	52	4.44
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	63.5%	30.8%	5.8%	0.0%	0.0%	52	4.58
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	51.9%	34.6%	13.5%	0.0%	0.0%	52	4.38
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	46.2%	32.7%	15.4%	5.8%	0.0%	52	4.19
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	50.0%	40.4%	7.7%	1.9%	0.0%	52	4.38

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	48.1%	34.6%	15.4%	1.9%	0.0%	52	4.29
Overall, this course was	28.8%	28.8%	36.5%	5.8%	0.0%	52	3.81

Other Course Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comment
Lectures
Defenitely the recording of lectures.
I appreciate the class recordings being available to us on Canvas. It made the class very easy to review or go over things that were said in class. It makes it easy to be in person and just be fully present in class, knowing you'll be able to go back and note everything if needed.
The weekly quizzes.
I really enjoyed that Professor Bolfarine engaged his students in learning and tried to make relatable comparisons to the course content. While this is a subject I struggle with, Professor Bolfarine tried to make it fun and was a really enjoyable professor.
it was effective how bolfarine was very helpful and attentive to clarifying topics i didnt understand.
Coding alongside the professor, but would've loved some more interactiveness.
In class rstudio practice
The homework and the in class participation.
Aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping my learning were having access to the textbook, and the weekly quizzes.
One of the most effective aspects of the course was the in-class lab work. Getting to actually run code, encounter real errors, and work through them step-by-step made the material much clearer. Seeing how the concepts applied directly in RStudio helped me understand not just what to do, but why things worked the way they did. Being able to troubleshoot code in real time gave me a lot more confidence and made the learning feel hands-on and practical.
He was very detailed and gave us good study materials for quizzes and exams
The Lectures and Homeworks
Prof. made the subject fun
Detailed information was provided, it most effective in helping my learning.
The aspects of this course that were the most effective in helping my learning were the engaging lectures and lab recordings.
I feel that the professor was very good at explaining concepts, very approachable, and accommodating to his students.
The canvas page with recordings of past lectures & "labs" with scripts attached was extremely helpful for my understanding of class material.
Attending classes.
Class slides, practice assignments, class recordings, class structure.
Professor Bolfarine always made sure we understood what was going on, and if we didn't he'd stop class and re-explain everything.
It was great that he let us work on quizzes in a good time manner, and also explained topics simply.
Rewatching lecture videos and learning more about the coding.
I think the recorded lectures that were posted on the home page was really helpful for me. It help me learn the material outside of class and clear up any confusions I had. It was a great resource to use also while preparing for exams.
I loved the professors style of teaching and found the labs + office hours very helpful.
When Professor Bolfarine lectures he uses 3rd person dilogy , and this kept me engaged because his sense of humor allowed me to effectively listen to him lecture.
The structure and organization of lectures and additional lab videos were the most effective
I appreciated how he would repeat himself to get the point across, that type of learning makes it stick to my brain better. He also has extra videos we can watch that he explains the material more thoroughly without time constraints.
Lab recordings
homeworks, recorded labs
The professor was very thorough and engaging, while also being very understanding with us students. This allowed me to focus on truly learning the content.
Definitely having the recorded lectures and the lab videos
I think the in person lectures were most helpful in the learning since he went through the r studio aspect and uploaded the notes as well.

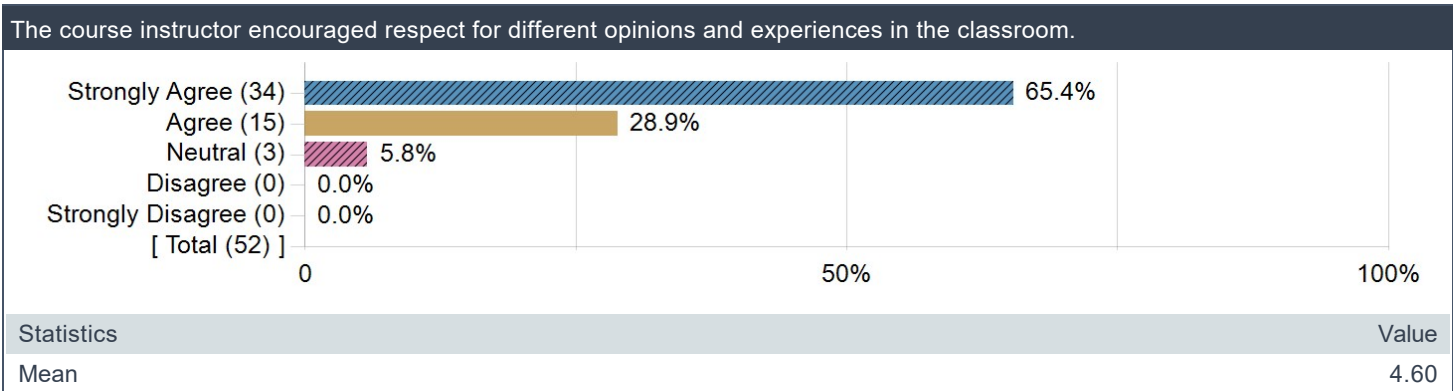
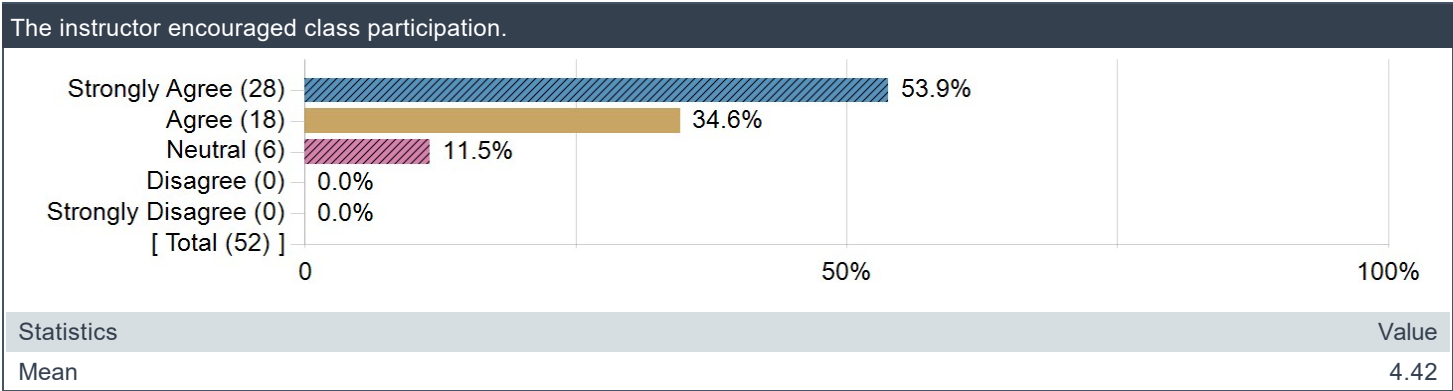
Comment
The multiple videos
The homework after the class and before the quiz was efficient.
I like the weekly quiz, because it allowed to have a consistency with my studying and know the concepts deeply.
The engaging questions that identified with the audience.
The Professor was the best Prof. I have ever had, hilarious, made complex and difficult lectures easy. Great guy.
The most effective aspect of the course that helped me learn was doing the code with the professor throughout the lessons. I feel like it just helped me understand better.
Homeworks and doing the r code in class
Professor Bolfarine was very helpful in terms of class quizzes
Uploading class recordings and R scripts
He is genuinely so sweet and takes time to help us students understand the content step by step. You can tell he really loves teaching and helping his students, and it's evident in his teaching. Breaks very complicated topics step by step, and allows us to ask questions no matter what they may be. Would recommend him to ANYONE who has to take STA235, would take him again in a heartbeat.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comment
The topic in general was difficult
The material is probably the hardest.
One of the most challenging things were the in-class quizzes in the beginning of each class. I believe if they were to become an interactive thing between classmates it would make it more efficient. There were many times where I would see a question on a quiz and would get stuck, I feel if someone had mentioned their own take on the question we could have collaborated better and ended up with a better outcome in class.
The homeworks were a bit challenging but prepared us for the exams well
The content of Stats 235 is crammed into a 2 hour, one day a week course. This doesn't allow the professor to cover content consistently and forces students to learn so much content in little time.
the course itself
The most challenging were our most challenging. I believe this is not necessary because most people will not be going into data science. Although useful, it is important to know that the rapidity in which we move was too much alongside with the amount of content.
I wish we had more practice with rstudio before classes to better understand.
I found it most challenging to learn the code.
Potentially the chapters on decision trees and time series.
The most challenging aspect of the course for me was the difficulty of the material itself. Coming from STA 301, I already struggled with some of the foundational concepts, so certain topics in this class felt overwhelming at times. Even when I tried to stay on top of the work, the pace and complexity made it hard to fully grasp everything as quickly as I wanted to.
The class is difficult and, especially because it only meets once a week and grades come out too late to really ask about. I feel like this course should be a 3 hour course and meet twice to better digest information.
The coding portion of the course (R)
Heavy on the content
Some complex information was hard to parse.
I found the homework to be challenging because I struggle with coding. I would suggest that future students attend SI sessions as well as look at the lab recordings.
I think that the professor was really great but the course itself wasn't very organized because there was may too much content given for one class a week. I think in the future giving more time for students to grasp concepts fully would be beneficial.
In-class lectures included quizzes with challenging content that was not always fully reviewed. Quick 1–2 debriefs after the quizzes to evaluate what was being tested would be helpful in the future.
Time on quizzes. Maybe less quizzes with longer time.
Having the course one day out of the week, the overwhelming amount of content being taught in one day, having to learn subjects

Comment
from stats 1 that were forgotten. I believe if the course was simplified a little more and narrowed down with content it would be easier to follow along.
The material was hard but that's just the course itself
I feel like the topics got a bit too complicated at times such as Time Series
The quizzes and homework were most challenging because sometimes it would have some general questions that I did not feel I learned from our lecture.
I think understanding the code at first after not doing R for 2 years was hard. I'd say putting more emphasis on the basics in the beginning was really helpful in helping me understand the content a lot better. I think continuing on to do this would help future students understand the complex topics easier.
The content itself was very challenging, so I found the course to be pretty difficult overall. One thing that could be done to help future students is have more office hours as the TA's may not be able to explain all the topics as clearly. Also, hold more exam review sessions in smaller groups. Besides the content, I found the quizzes to be very stressful. I knew the purpose of it was to check for understanding, but since I kept performing poorly despite studying, it took a toll on my grade. I hope it is not weighted as heavily in the future.
The quizzes at the beginning of class are what I found the most challenging. One thing I would suggest that could be done to help future students on the quizzes is to create groups. Groups ranging 3–4, where they are able to collaborate on the quizzes and hear other perspectives.
The challenging aspect was the material of lecture not aligning with the homework sometimes as they caused confusion in learning.
The quizzes were challenging but I think it was more because I wasn't used to the style of it from the previous STA 301 course. I think it would be good to keep the quizzes group related.
In class quizzes, there is a lot of confusion about correct interpretations– diagnostic plots. Adding new concepts that have seemingly little relevance to the class: random forests
weekly quizzes
I think there was a lot of experimentation this semester, and it felt a little disorganized and chaotic at times. For example, for the midterm the program we used was super slow/glitchy and made it hard to focus which I feel like affected my grade. Now for the final, we are using a new program that I have never used before. I know that the professors are working towards finding the best option I just wish things were figured out beforehand.
I think the class is not the most engaging, I know its not supposed to be fun but i found myself pretty bored and in turn following in r almost seemed robotic
I think the most challenging was the in person quizzes and the lockdown browser issues that we had.
I found the exam the most challenging because it was on an unreliable website and crashed alot I think improving the exam structure would improve the course drastically
The quizzes were a bit challenging, but if we collaborate and work together on them, the students will meet the challenge more effectively.
The most challenging part is the interpretation aspect of the code in RStudio, because there many things that you need to consider or be mindful of.
The coding and explanations were a bit confusing.
The course was changing structure, too much to handle for a two hour course.
An aspect of the course that I found most challenging was the quizzes. I feel like they were conceptually focused which doesn't prepare you for the exam since we have to do the code ourselves for the exam; however, for the quizzes, the output was given. Overall, the structure of the quizzes was very weird.
The quizzes every class and the exams.
The course material itself was very difficult. I think also attending class once a week for two hours made it difficult to really grasp the subject at hand versus attending class twice a week.
R studio
The material and topics are overall just challenging, but has nothing to do with his teaching. Maybe we could practice more on the open ended responses when it comes exam time.

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

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